

GUIDE TO OVERCLOCKING PHONES (ANDROID)

Power users constantly strive to derive extra performance from their devices.

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Smartphones of 2018 were a wonder to behold. They accomplished things that users couldn't imagine just a few years ago. However, despite how good they get, smartphones, especially droids, tend to age pretty quickly. Users that do not have the ability to constantly upgrade their smartphone every year or so, might achieve the much-needed boost in speed, through overclocking. There is no better platform than Android to achieve enhanced performance by tweaking your device through operations such as rooting and overclocking. Android purists are often grateful for the customisability the OS provides them and for good reason. You can squeeze out a considerable number of years from a phone that would otherwise render itself unusable or very unpleasant to use.



You can boost up your old smartphone

WHAT IS OVERCLOCKING

Essentially, overclocking is the process by which you can force your CPU to run at speeds that are faster than its original intended speed. Hardcore and professional PC gamers have been long advocates of overclocking their hardware to push their machines to maximum (or close to) potential. You can do the same with Android as well. Mobile gaming is constantly becoming more taxing and intensive on the phone's processor, which warrants this, now, more than ever. It can give you as much as 30 per cent of extra power. However, your device will need to be rooted for this process to work.

Overclocking is facilitated through downloading the right kernel, also known as bootloader, for your device. It is one of the first programs loaded onto your device and performs several vital tasks such as running processes, managing the hard disk, handling interrupts and the rest of the startup process.

Disclaimer: Overclocking your device comes with a few risks such as more heat generation and battery drainage.

GETTING THE RIGHT KERNEL

Overclocking is sort of a staple process in the modding community, so there is absolutely no shortage of kernels on the internet. You need to locate a kernel for the specific model of your phone, a

great place to start would be XDA-Developers. First, you will need to find the model number of your device by going to Settings > About Phone. Also, note the version of Android you are currently using. Search for a kernel with the model number of your phone.



Android, by default, uses the Linux kernel.

You must keep four things in mind while picking a kernel - it must support overclocking (of course!), must be compatible with your phone model, should work on your current version of Android, and finally, it should have a good reputation (You don't want your phone to brick, do you?). Try to pick a popular kernel, since you can easily obtain feedback and help in case you encounter any pressing issues.

Once you have picked a kernel, download a generic overclocking or CPU manager app. This will be used to change your CPU clock speeds after